Task Sheet No. 11:
TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

INSTRUCTION:

As a pre-service teacher, you are tasked to write a **Teaching Philosophy Essay** that articulates your beliefs, values, and principles about teaching and learning. In your essay, discuss your view of the role of the teacher and learners, how learning takes place, the importance of creating an inclusive and supportive learning environment, and the teaching strategies you believe are most effective. Connect your beliefs to your observations and personal experiences during your Field Study 1 and 2, and relevant educational theories or principles, and explain how these beliefs will guide your future teaching practice. Your essay should be clear, reflective, well-organized, and grounded in your developing professional identity as future educator.

RUBRIC FOR GRADING:

CRITERIA	EXCELLENT	PROFICIENT	DEVELOPING	BEGINNING
Teaching and Learning Beliefs (25%)	Clearly and thoughtfully articulates well-developed beliefs about teaching and learning, supported by relevant educational principles or theories.	Clearly presents relevant beliefs about teaching and learning with some connection to educational principles.	Presents general beliefs but provides limited explanation or connection to educational principles.	Provides unclear, limited, or unsupported beliefs about teaching and learning.
Role of Teacher and Learners (25%)	Provides a clear and insightful discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners and their relationship in the learning process.	Clearly discusses the roles of the teacher and learners with appropriate explanation.	Discusses the roles of the teacher and learners but with limited depth or clarity.	Provides minimal or unclear discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners.
Application to Practice Teaching (25%)	Clearly explains how the philosophy will guide specific teaching practices, classroom decisions, and interactions with diverse learners.	Explains how the philosophy can guide future teaching practice with relevant examples.	Provides general connections to future teaching practice with limited examples.	Makes little or no connection between the philosophy and future teaching practice.
Reflection and Professional Identity (25%)	Demonstrates deep self-reflection and clearly connects personal experiences and insights to the development of a professional teaching identity.	Demonstrates thoughtful reflection and makes relevant connections to professional growth.	Includes some reflection but connections to professional identity are limited.	Shows little evidence of reflection or developing professional identity.

MY TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

NAME OF PRE-SERVICE TEACHER: Kimberlie Crissel F. Porteria

TITLE: I've Been in Your Seat: Teaching Through Empathy

Teaching is rarely a one-size-fits-all endeavor, and as a student of technical-vocational teacher education, I carry the demands of being a learner while developing my identity as an educator. This dual perspective is the pillar of my teaching philosophy: effective teaching is rooted in empathy, the ability to put oneself in the students' shoes and make sense of what the educational system is asking of them. My beliefs are anchored in Progressive Education and constructivism. John Dewey argued that learning is most meaningful when it grows from students' interests and active experience, which is especially true in technical-vocational education, where competence is built by doing. Constructivism adds that learners build knowledge by connecting new ideas to what they already know, so my lessons begin with something students can try or question. I also draw on Krashen's affective filter hypothesis for when students feel anxious, embarrassed, or bored, learning is blocked. A supportive and enjoyable environment is therefore a condition for learning, not a bonus.

I see the teacher not as a rigid authority figure but as an empathic facilitator who designs the conditions for learning. Facilitation is shared work where learners are active partners who participate, ask questions, take ownership of their practice, and support peers through collaboration and honest feedback. It is my responsibility to spark the initial curiosity but also theirs to bring effort to constructing their own knowledge. When students lack eagerness despite my utmost efforts, I choose to see it as a challenge of connection rather than a personal failure or a flaw in the learners, and then I ask what is getting in the way before deciding what to change.

In practice, I constantly ask myself: *What would have helped me understand this topic when I was first learning it?* That question shapes how I plan lessons, instructional videos, and activities, breaking dense material into interactive segments with an element of fun, such as gamified checkpoints that lower students' anxiety and boredom. For learners who are slower or less confident, I would provide step-by-step guides, worked examples, and peer partners; for those who finish early, extension challenges. Because learners differ in language background, pace, and resources, I would let them show mastery through a practical performance, a short explanation, or a game-based checkpoint, and I would check understanding mid-lesson so I can adjust on the spot.

During my field study, I taught Accounting Books to Grade 11 - Zobel. I had prepared a hands-on, collaborative lesson meant to make dense material feel approachable, but some students lacked eagerness and did not engage with it. I tried adapting my approach to reach them, and while many students came along, a few stayed distant despite my most concerted efforts. That moment taught me that engagement cannot be forced; it has to be invited in a way students can relate to, and silence is a signal to listen to, not a verdict on the learner. It also showed me my limits, that I am still learning to read a room quickly and to adjust an activity in real time when students' energy drops. Being both a student and a future teacher helps, because I know how it feels to sit through a lesson that doesn't connect. My professional identity is defined by resilience and a commitment to my students' holistic growth. Even on the hardest days, I will keep adapting my methods so no student is left behind simply because the traditional approach failed to reach them, while treating my own growth and rest as part of sustaining that care. Ultimately, I aim to be an educator who not only teaches skills but truly understands the students sitting across from me.